



BADMINTON

COURSE OVERVIEW

Badminton is a high-speed racquet sport played by either two opposing players (Singles) or two opposing pairs (Doubles), occupying opposite halves of a rectangular court divided by a net. Players score points by striking a shuttlecock with their racquet over the net to land inside the opponent's court boundary. Each side is allowed a single contact to return the shuttlecock before it crosses the net. A rally ends immediately when the shuttlecock hits the floor, lands out of bounds, or when a rule violation (fault) occurs.

1. BRIEF HISTORY OF BADMINTON

- **Origins in India:** The game traces its roots to an ancient Indian game called "Poona," which was played as an upper-class leisure activity.
- **Governing Body:** In **1934**, the **International Badminton Federation (IBF)** was established. Today, it is known as the **Badminton World Federation (BWF)**, serving as the official global governing body for international competitions.
- **Olympic Debut:** Badminton officially became an Olympic medal sport in 1992.
- **Olympic Disciplines:** Features 5 official events:
 1. Men's Singles
 2. Women's Singles
 3. Men's Doubles
 4. Women's Doubles
 5. Mixed Doubles (*one male and one female player per side*)

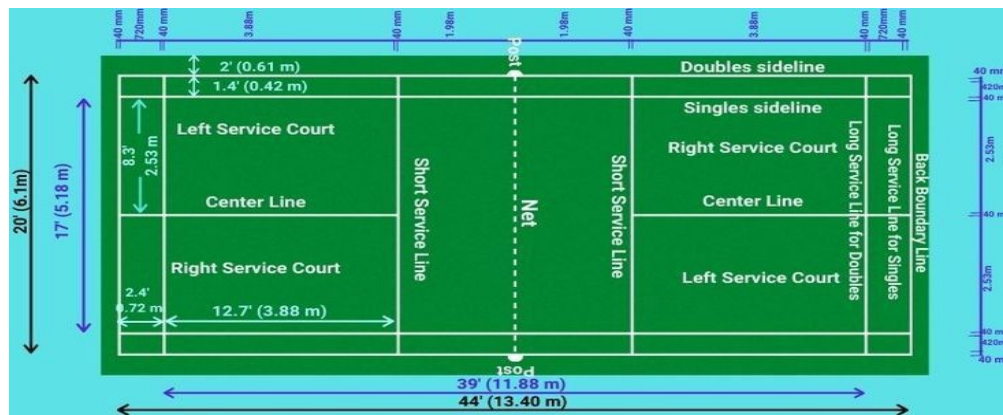
2. FACILITIES & EQUIPMENT

A. The Badminton Court

- **Court Length:** 44 feet (13.40 m) for both Singles and Doubles.
- **Singles Width:** 17 feet (5.18 m) (*Long and narrow playing area*).
- **Doubles Width:** 20 feet (6.10 m) (*Includes the side alley boundaries*).
- **Short Service Line:** Located 1.98 meters (6.5 ft) from the net on both sides.
- **Center Line:** Divides the court perpendicularly to separate the Left and Right Service Courts.

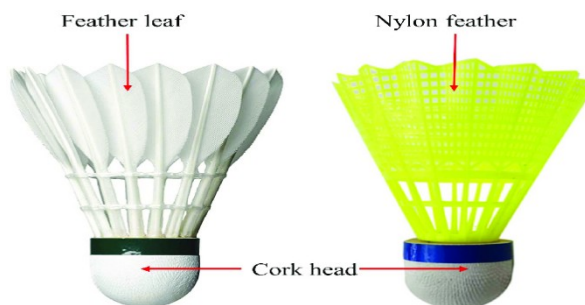
B. The Net and Posts

- **Net Height:** 5 feet (1.524 m) at the center; 5 feet 1 inch (1.55 m) at the posts.
- **Net Depth:** 2 feet 6 inches (0.76 m).
- **Posts:** Positioned directly over the doubles sidelines regardless of whether singles or doubles is



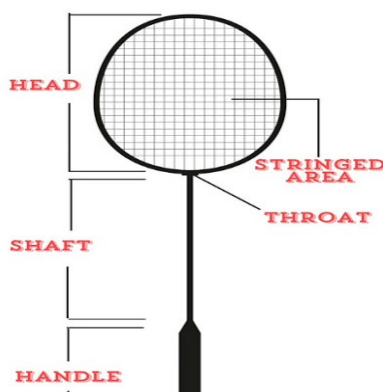
C. The Shuttlecock ("Birdie")

- **Feathered Shuttlecock:** Constructed from **16 natural goose feathers** inserted into a leather-covered cork base.
- **Synthetic Shuttlecock:** Made from durable nylon or plastic, commonly used for recreational or instructional play.



D. The Racquet

- **Structure:** Composed of the **Head** (*stringed area*), **Throat**, **Shaft**, **Handle**, and **Butt Cap**.
- **Specifications:** Maximum length of 68 cm; typically lightweight, weighing around 80–100 grams.
- **Materials:** Crafted from aluminum, graphite, carbon fiber, or composite synthetic metals.





3. HANDGRIPS IN BADMINTON

1. Forehand Grip ("Handshake Grip")

- **Technique:** Wrap the thumb and index finger around the handle to form a distinct **"V" shape** along the top bevel, while the remaining fingers wrap comfortably below to support the bottom handle.
- **Application:** Used for strokes executed on the dominant side of the body and overhead shots.

2. Backhand Grip

- **Technique:** From the forehand grip, slightly adjust fingers to press the **thumb flat** against the wide flat surface of the handle, with the other fingers rest together.
- **Application:** Used for strokes on the non-dominant side of the body. The flat thumb leverage adds power to overcome the non-dominant side.

3. Bevel Grip ("Corner Bevel Grip")

- **Technique:** Position the thumb flat against one of the slanted, diagonal corner bevels of the octagonal handle (between the top bevel and the wide flat side).
- **Application:** Used for backhand overhead shots (such as backhand clears or drop shots) and fast rear-court backhand defense where a full backhand grip restricts wrist movement.

4. Panhandle Grip ("Frying Pan Grip")

- **Technique:** Turn the racquet face so it is parallel to the net, pinching the wide flat side of the handle between the thumb and index finger as if holding a frying pan.
- **Application:** Used primarily at the net for fast net kills, net taps, and forehand drive interceptions right above the net tape.



Forehand



Backhand



Bevel



Panhandle



4. THE 4 COMMON BADMINTON STROKES

- **Forehand Stroke:** Executed with the palm leading the swing (knuckles trailing).
- **Backhand Stroke:** Executed with the back of the hand/knuckles leading the swing.

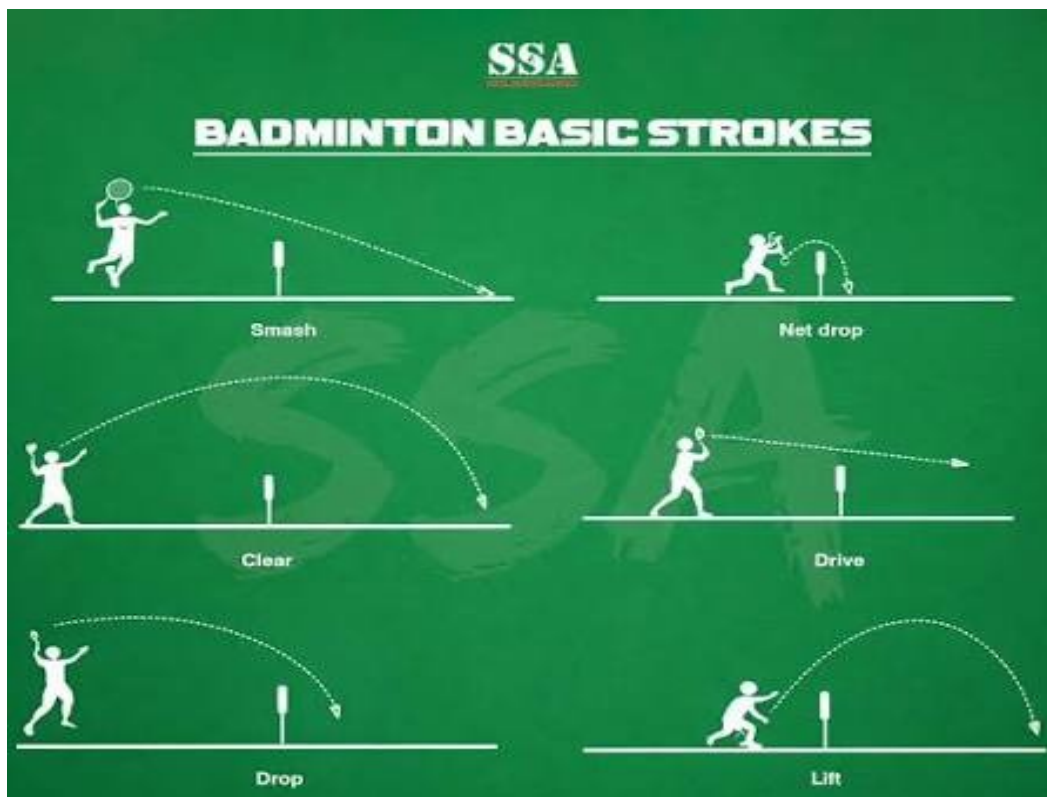
1. Smash / Kill: An aggressive, steep overhead attack hit forcefully downward into the opponent's court.

2. Drop: A delicate precision stroke played softly over the net, causing the shuttlecock to steep down and fall just past the net.

3. Clear: A deep defensive or offensive shot hitting the shuttlecock high in an arc, forcing it to drop near the opponent's back boundary line.

4. Drive: A fast, powerful, flat trajectory shot hit parallel over the net on a straight path.

5. Lift (Underarm Clear): An underarm shot hit upwards and deep to the opponent's backcourt, executed near the net to push the opponent back and buy time to recover position.





5. RULES & REGULATIONS

Game Setup & Scoring

1. **Match Format:** Played as best 2-out-of-3 sets.
2. **Scoring System:** The first side to reach **21 points** wins the set. Points are awarded on every rally (rally scoring).
3. **Service Court Position (Odd / Even Rule):**
 - o **Even Scores (0, 2, 4, 6...):** Serve from and receive in the **Right Service Court**.
 - o **Odd Scores (1, 3, 5, 7...):** Serve from and receive in the **Left Service Court**.
4. **Toss:** Every official match begins with a coin toss or shuttle drop. The winner chooses to serve first, receive, or pick a side of the court.

Service Execution Rules

- **Underarm Service:** The server's racquet head must strike the shuttlecock below the server's waist level in an underarm motion. Overarm serves are illegal.
- **Contact Point:** The server must strike the rubber/cork base of the shuttlecock, not the feathers.
- **Diagonal Service:** Serves must travel diagonally across the net into the receiver's service court.
- **Doubles Serve Receiving:** Only the player standing diagonally opposite the server may return the service. If the partner touches or returns the serve, a fault is called and a point is awarded to the serving team.

Common Faults & Penalties

- **Foot Fault:** Stepping on or over boundary lines while serving or receiving.
- **Net Contact:** Touching the net or posts with your body, clothing, or racquet during active play.
- **Double Hit:** Hitting the shuttlecock twice consecutively on the same court side.
- **Out of Bounds:** Shuttlecock landing completely outside boundary lines.



Feinting / Unsportsmanlike Distraction: Deliberately distracting, mocking, or feinting an opponent during service execution.

Disqualifying Misconduct: The referee or umpire has the authority to penalize or disqualify a player for severe or continuous misconduct.

6. OFFICIAL TERMINOLOGY

- **Backcourt:** The rear third of the court near the back boundary lines.
- **Carry (Sling / Throw):** An illegal stroke where the shuttle is caught or held on the racquet face before release.
- **Centre Line:** Line dividing the left and right service courts perpendicularly from the net.
- **Flick:** A sudden rotation of the wrist and forearm to transform a soft shot into a fast, deceptive drive/clear.
- **Long Service Line:** The back boundary line in singles; in doubles, a line 2.5 feet inside the back boundary line past which the serve cannot land.
- **Rally:** Continuous exchange of shots determining a point.
- **Short Service Line:** The boundary line located 1.98 meters in front of the net.
- **Wood Shot:** A legal hit where the shuttlecock contacts the frame of the racquet.



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